Chapter 35

Kiran's Farewell to the UN:
She Returns Home to Manipulations

KIRAN SPOKE IN THE TOWN HALL JUST BEFORE SHE LEFT THE UNITED Nations after two years' service as police adviser in the Department of Peace-keeping Operations:

> Goodbye, United Nations – for now.
> I spent two years with the United Nations, and the time has flown. When the days were passing by, they appeared moving at a snail's pace, for I missed my home. For this was my first long professional commitment overseas. But now when I look back, the days are going, going and gone! Only for now – for I am leaving behind unfinished work. This is nothing unusual. No, not for me. Equally perhaps for many others. But the question is – is this preordained? Or is it an act of Nature – to conspire to leave matters incomplete in different phases of one's life?
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> One life is never enough. I believe it becomes a reason to return. The more one does, the more there is to do. And in attempting to complete the pending tasks, we create newer ones. Hence, every time, work is left incomplete. Homework left unfinished has to be revisited in the next lifetime – that's what my teachers told me when I was small. And that made us children finish our daily homework. Then I was small and afraid of the teacher, and now I have grown to be one myself. Now I think I know what I still do not know. I want to know the mysteries of life and living, but I may never get to know them.
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> But one thing I do instinctively know is that I may be reborn because of the 'sins' I have committed as a cop in my life, such as getting the persons in custody to speak up, or dispersing, cane-charging, tear-gassing, arresting, putting in prison and even opening fire to disperse unlawful assemblies? And in the process, I received some certificates – at their cost! If that is not enough, towing away by cranes, as they are also called back home, the wrongly parked cars of my friends and the MPs and getting nicknamed 'Crane Bedi'.
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> At the United Nations, I learnt the art of creating a permanent seat or place for myself – read 'for next life' – by leaving unfinished work. However, I do admit this is not something unique to the United Nations. I am internally convinced that I brought it along from my work experience in India. My leaving the work half-way is today a 'strategic' (my boss's favourite word) plan. I learnt all about strategies and added the doctrine of reincarnation or 'over the horizon' and 'institutional memory'. In other words, I made a doctrinal shift! If I give you one more such acquisition, it is the making of a CONOPS – concept of operations, as we called them – one of the most used acronyms in the Department of Peace-keeping Operations. And who says we from the Police Division did not make enough? With or without the help of the OO (Office of Operations)! All our most used jargons!